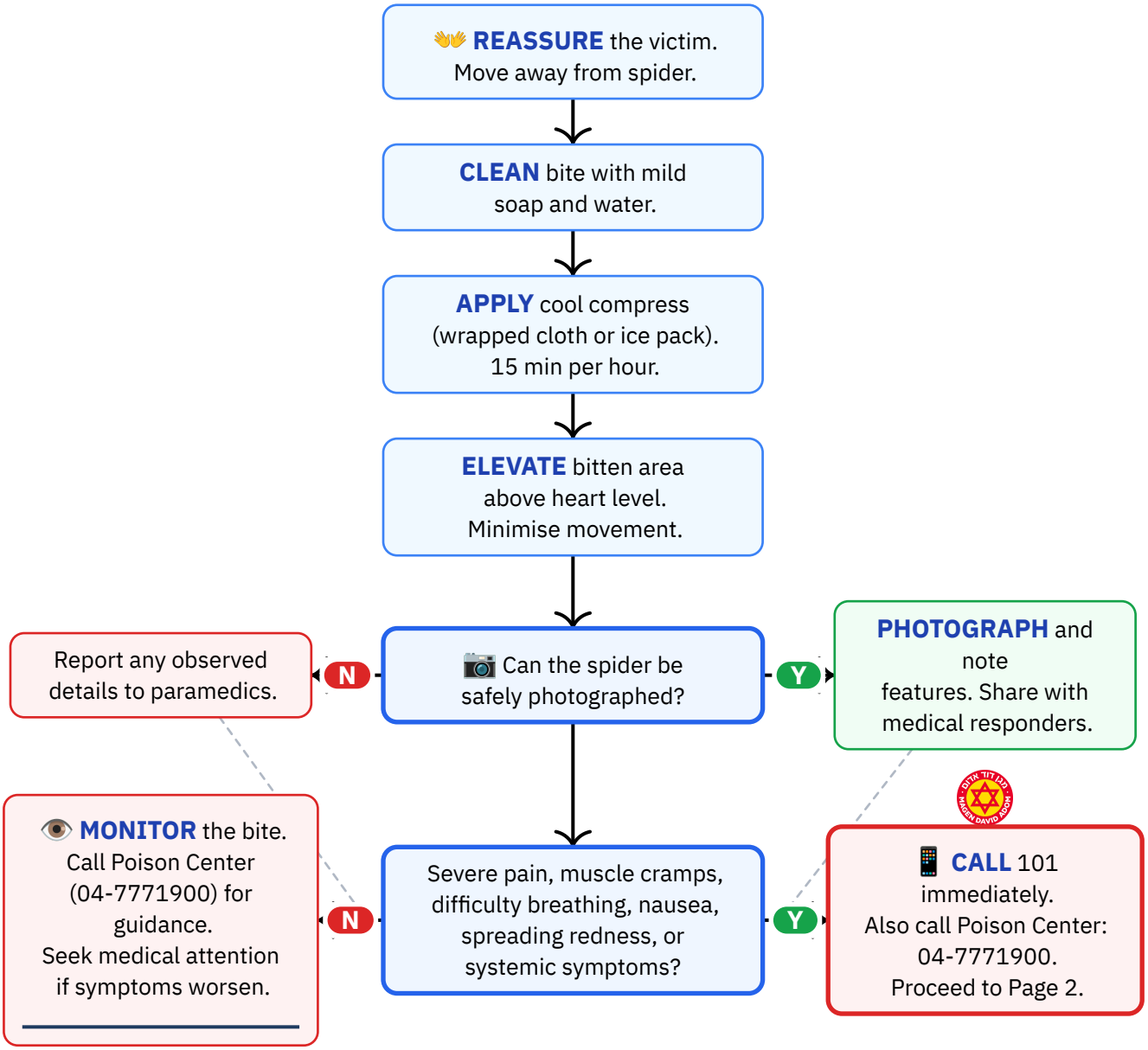

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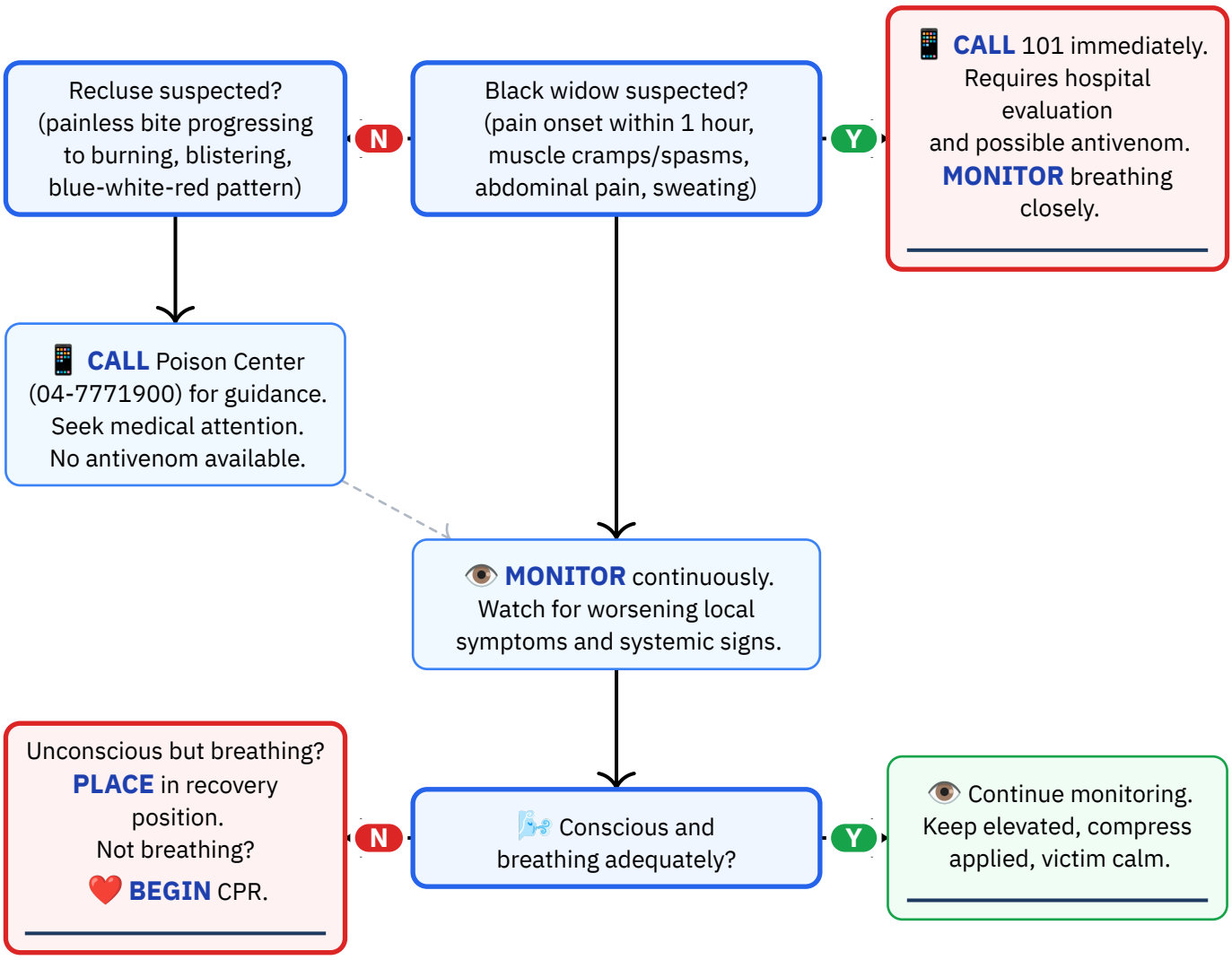
Species Assessment & Monitoring



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Reference Notes

DO NOT:

✕ **Do NOT apply a tourniquet** – spider venom is not stopped by tourniquets; causes tissue damage.
✕ **Do NOT cut, suck, or apply suction** to the bite wound – ineffective and increases infection risk.
✕ **Do NOT apply heat** to the bite – use only cool compresses.
✕ **Do NOT attempt to catch the spider** at risk of additional bites – photograph from a safe distance.
✕ **Do NOT excise a recluse bite** – early surgical excision is contraindicated and worsens outcomes.
✕ **Do NOT apply ice directly** to skin – wrap in cloth first.
✕ **Do NOT ignore mild symptoms** – recluse bites are often painless at first but progress to serious necrosis over hours to days.
✕ **Do NOT assume it is a spider bite** without confirmation – 83.5% of cases presenting as "spider bites" are actually other conditions.

Equipment needed:

— Phone to call 101 (MDA) and 04-7771900 (Israel Poison Center)
— Phone or camera to photograph the spider if safe
— Mild soap and clean water for wound cleaning
— Clean cloth or wrapped ice pack for cool compress

Medically Significant Spiders in Israel

Species	Venom Type	Antivenom
Mediterranean recluse (Loxosceles rufescens) "violin spider"	Necrotoxic – painless bite progressing to tissue necrosis	Not available
Mediterranean black widow (Latrodectus tredecimguttatus)	Neurotoxic – pain, muscle cramps, abdominal spasms	Available for severe cases

Israel Poison Information Center: 04-7771900 (24/7, Rambam Hospital, Haifa)

Hebrew Terminology — מונחים בעברית

English	עברית	Pronunciation
Spider	עכביש	ak-a-VISH
Spider bite	עקיצת עכביש	a-ki-TSAT ak-a-VISH
Swelling	נפיחות	ne-fi-KHUT
Pain	כאב	ke-EV
Muscle cramps	התכווצויות שרירים	hit-kav-tsu-YOT shri-RIM
Poison center	מרכז רעלים	mer-KAZ re-a-LIM
Ambulance	אמבולנס	am-bu-LANS
Emergency	חירום	khe-RUM
I was bitten	ננשכתי	ni-SHAKH-ti

Source: Magen David Adom (MDA) — First Aid for Spider Bites
URL: https://www.mdais.org/media/4954/mda-first-aid-guidelines-en.pdf
Publication date: Standing public guidance
Imported: 2026-03-16 · **Last verified:** 2026-03-16

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